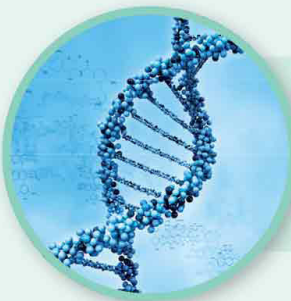


Reproduction and growth

Every child grows from a fertilized egg that contains body-building instructions inherited from both parents. This egg divides to produce trillions of cells that make up a baby growing inside its mother's body, like the one shown here. After it is born, the baby passes through a series of life stages that take it to adulthood and, eventually, old age.



DNA

Our cells contain DNA—two spiral strands twisted around each other. This substance holds the instructions for creating a human being.